3 AI hook effects *that stop the scroll*

Every prompt I used to make an Instagram post pour out cotton candy, my inbox fold into paper planes and strawberries melt out of my phone. Copy, paste, swap in your details.



pop out



paper plane



melt

BEFORE YOU START

Your hook isn't the first sentence. *It's the first second.*

People scroll past talking. They stop for the thing that shouldn't be possible. That's what these three effects do: an everyday piece of your phone suddenly behaves like a real object.

Here's the honest bit. When I first made these, the cards above my head were blank. AI video models are brilliant at movement and terrible at spelling, so I asked for grey lines instead of words. It looked weird. Nobody stops for a blank email.

The trick that fixed it: I made the first frame as a still image, with the exact words on it, and then let the video model animate from that frame. Image models can spell. Video models can move. Use each for what it's good at.

What you need

- A Higgsfield account. At the time of writing, each 10 second, 1080p clip on Seedance 2.5 cost me 120 credits.
- 6 to 10 photos of yourself: clear face, front, sides and back, natural light, no heavy filters. Wear the outfit you want in the videos.
- One simple set you'll reuse for every effect. Mine is a bed, a plain wall and a lamp. Lots of empty wall above your head matters.
- CapCut (or any editor) to put the clips together and add the effect names.



my reference photos

The workflow, in 3 steps:

1. **Lock your look** with a character sheet.
2. **Put the words in a still**: the start frame.
3. **Animate from it** with Seedance 2.5.

Make one video at a time. Check it, then make the next.

STEP 1

1 Lock your *look*

The character sheet keeps your face and outfit the same in every clip. Everything else depends on it, so make a few and keep the one that looks most like you.

Higgsfield › Images | GPT Image 2.5 | quality: high | 16:9 | upload all your photos

PROMPT · CHARACTER SHEET

Photorealistic character reference sheet of the exact real woman shown in all the reference photos. Preserve her identity precisely: same face shape, nose, eyes, lips, jaw, eyebrows, skin and age as in the photos. Do not beautify, age up or alter her features. [HAIR, e.g. long softly wavy light honey-brown hair worn down past her chest, with wispy curtain bangs parted in the centre], [EYES, e.g. light blue-grey eyes], [SKIN, e.g. fair skin with natural texture], [MAKEUP AND JEWELLERY, e.g. classic red lipstick, small gold hoops, a thin ring on her left hand].

Outfit exactly as in the references: [YOUR OUTFIT, e.g. oversized soft cream-oatmeal sweatshirt with a polo collar and short button placket, dark plum-brown high-waisted flared leggings, chunky cream and silver retro trainers, dark burgundy smartwatch strap on her left wrist]. No bag.

Layout: three views side by side on a clean white seamless studio background with soft even natural light. Left: full body head to toe facing camera, relaxed pose, one hand on hip. Centre: full body head to toe back view. Right: head-and-shoulders 3/4 portrait with a slight relaxed smile. Real unretouched photo look, natural skin texture, visible pores, no beauty filter, no airbrushing. Exactly one woman per panel. No text, no labels, no logos.



"do not beautify" is what makes it look like you

STEP 2

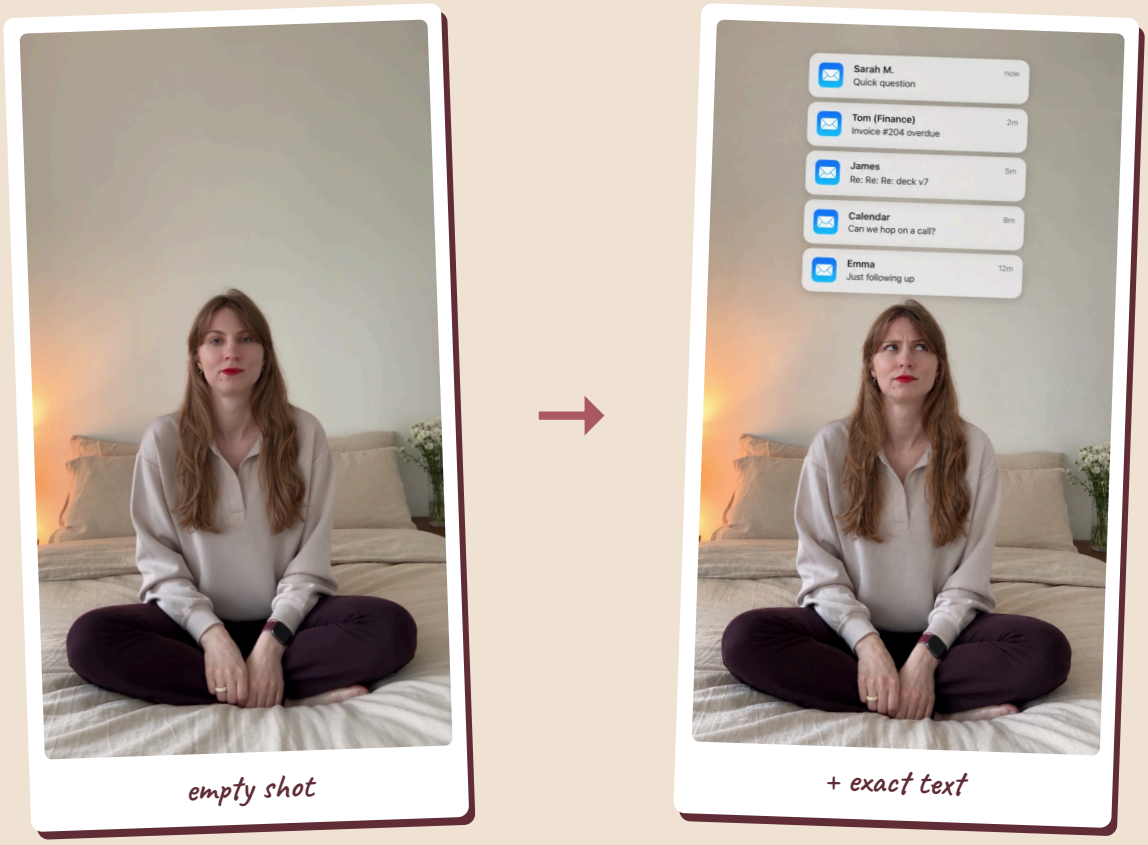
2 Put the words *in a still*

First you need one clean shot of you on your set, with empty space above your head. I grabbed a still from a test clip. If you don't have one, generate it:

PROMPT · YOUR EMPTY SET (GPT IMAGE 2.5, 9:16, HIGH)

Photorealistic phone camera photo, 9:16 vertical, of the exact woman in the reference photos and character sheet, same face, same outfit. Do not beautify her. She sits cross-legged in the centre of a neatly made bed with [BEDDING, e.g. cream linen bedding and two pale pillows], a plain [WALL COLOUR] wall behind her, [DETAILS, e.g. a warm glowing bedside lamp on the left and a small vase of white flowers on the right]. Soft daylight. Camera on a tripod at eye level, framed from her knees to well above her head, with lots of clear empty wall space above her head. She looks at the camera, relaxed. Natural skin texture. No text, no watermark.

Then, for each effect, give GPT Image 2.5 that empty shot as **image 1**, plus a front photo and a close-up of your face, and ask it to add the interface with the exact words. You'll find each start frame prompt with its effect on the next pages.



Check the spelling before you animate. Zoom in on every word. If one letter is off, regenerate the still. Fixing a still is much easier than fixing a video.

STEP 3

3 Animate *from it*

Higgsfield › Videos | Seedance 2.5 | reference mode | 1080p | 9:16 | 10 sec | audio on

References for every effect

- **Start frame:** the still you made in step 2.
- **Reference 1:** your clearest front-facing photo.
- **Reference 2:** your character sheet.

What made the prompts work

- **Write it second by second**, like a director: 0 to 3 s, 3 to 6 s, and so on.
- **Say exactly what crosses the edge.** "The cotton candy comes OUT through the bottom edge of the photo" works. "Cotton candy appears" doesn't.
- **List the text that must stay sharp**, word for word, and add "no garbled or changing text" to the negative line.
- **Lock the camera.** One continuous tripod shot. The magic reads better when nothing else moves.
- **Decline the preset.** If Higgsfield suggests one, say no and generate your prompt as written.

The block I start every prompt with

PROMPT · OPENING BLOCK (PASTE FIRST, EVERY TIME)

Start exactly from the start frame. CHARACTER, MANDATORY: exactly this real woman from the start frame and the reference photo: [HAIR], [EYES], [SKIN], [MAKEUP AND JEWELLERY], [OUTFIT, SAME WORDING AS STEP 1]. Her face never changes. Do not beautify.

CAMERA: ONE continuous locked-off tripod shot, 9:16, exactly the framing of the start frame. No cuts. Real phone-camera footage, natural daylight, real physics, five fingers on each hand.

EFFECT 1 OF 3

The *pop out* effect

START FRAME · GPT IMAGE 2.5, 9:16, HIGH

Keep image 1 exactly as it is: the same woman, same pose, same outfit, same room, same light, same framing. Her face must stay identical to image 1 and the real photos in images 2 and 3. Do not beautify her.

Add one floating Instagram post card in the empty space above her head, centred, about 70% of the frame width, crisp and realistic like a real iPhone Instagram post in light mode, with a soft drop shadow on the wall behind it so it looks physically present in the room. Top to bottom: a header row with a small round profile photo, the username "[YOUR HANDLE]" in bold and three dots; a square photo of [THE THING THAT COMES OUT, e.g. a huge fluffy swirl of pastel pink cotton candy on a paper stick, held by a hand, against a soft pink sky]; heart, comment, share and bookmark icons; "[NUMBER] likes" in bold; the caption "[YOUR HANDLE] [CAPTION]". All text must be sharp, correctly spelt and readable. Photorealistic phone camera photo, no other text, no watermark.



start frame

VIDEO · SEEDANCE 2.5 (AFTER THE OPENING BLOCK)

THE INSTAGRAM POST floating above her head is a real physical object in the room, casting a soft shadow on the wall. Its header, icons, "[YOUR HANDLE]", "[NUMBER] likes" and caption stay sharp and unchanged the whole time.

10-second shot.
0-3 s: She looks up, raises her right hand and flicks the post upward with one finger like scrolling a phone. The feed inside the card scrolls up fast in a motion blur of other posts, then springs back and settles on the same post.
3-6 s: Inside the photo, the hand holding the [THING] pushes it forward and DOWN; the [THING] physically comes OUT through the bottom edge of the photo, crossing over the white caption area and out of the card into the real room, now three-dimensional and real. The photo inside the card is now empty.
6-8 s: She reaches up with both hands and catches it; it is real and light, swaying slightly.
8-10 s: She brings it down, looks at it delighted, [TAKES A BITE / SMELLS IT / HUGS IT], then smiles at the camera.
AUDIO: quiet room ambience, a soft swipe whoosh and quick scrolling ticks, a playful magical shimmer as it comes out of the post, a soft puff when she catches it, a small happy laugh. No music, no dialogue.

NEGATIVE: no cuts, no extra people, no garbled or changing text on the post, no new text, no watermark, no captions, no morphing face, no plastic skin, no warped hands, no extra fingers, no outfit changes, no cartoon look.

Mine: the flick came early, so I trimmed the first second in the edit.

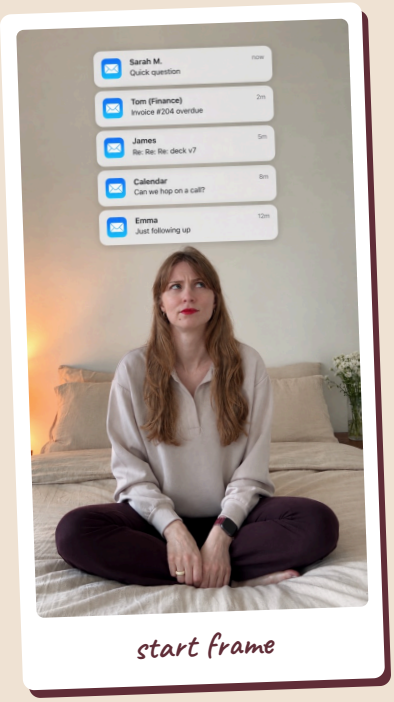
EFFECT 2 OF 3

The *paper plane* effect

START FRAME · GPT IMAGE 2.5, 9:16, HIGH

Keep image 1 exactly as it is: the same woman, same pose, same outfit, same room, same light, same framing. Her face must stay identical to image 1 and the real photos in images 2 and 3. Do not beautify her. She is looking up at the cards with one eyebrow raised, unimpressed.

Add a neat vertical stack of five floating email notification cards in the empty space above her head, centred, each about 75% of the frame width, with small gaps, like real iPhone lock-screen email notifications in light mode: white frosted rounded rectangles with a soft drop shadow on the wall behind. Each card: a small blue mail icon on the left, a bold sender name, a time on the right, and one line of subject text. Top to bottom:
1. "[NAME]" "now" "Quick question"
2. "[NAME] (Finance)" "2m" "Invoice #204 overdue"
3. "[NAME]" "5m" "Re: Re: Re: deck v7"
4. "[NAME]" "8m" "Can we hop on a call?"
5. "[NAME]" "12m" "Just following up"
All text must be sharp, correctly spelt and readable. Photorealistic phone camera photo, no other text, no watermark.



start frame

VIDEO · SEEDANCE 2.5 (AFTER THE OPENING BLOCK)

THE FIVE EMAIL NOTIFICATION CARDS floating above her head are real physical objects, casting soft shadows on the wall. Their text stays sharp, readable and unchanged until each card folds: [PASTE YOUR FIVE CARDS HERE, SENDER AND SUBJECT].

10-second shot.
0-2 s: The five cards hover in a neat stack, bobbing gently. She looks up at them, unimpressed, one eyebrow raised.
2-3 s: She raises her right hand clearly in front of her shoulder and clicks her fingers once, a crisp visible snap.
3-7 s: Starting from the bottom card, each card folds itself in mid-air into a white paper plane, real paper creases forming, the text folding inside. One by one all FIVE paper planes launch and glide away in different directions, out of the frame; one swoops close past the lens.
7-9 s: The space above her head is empty. She brushes her palms together, dusting off her hands.
9-10 s: She gives a small satisfied smile to camera.
AUDIO: quiet room ambience, five soft notification pings at the start, a loud crisp finger snap, crisp paper folding sounds, light whooshes as each plane flies off. No music, no dialogue.

NEGATIVE: no cuts, no extra people, no garbled or changing text, no new text, no watermark, no captions, no morphing face, no plastic skin, no warped hands, no extra fingers, no outfit changes, no cartoon look.

Mine: the cards crumpled more than folded. Still works, and it's funnier.

EFFECT 3 OF 3

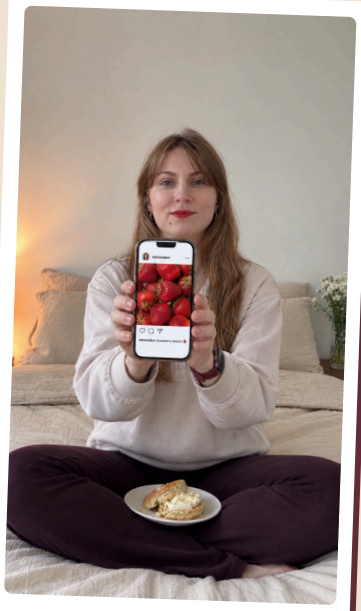
The *melt* effect

START FRAME · GPT IMAGE 2.5, 9:16, HIGH

Same woman, same room and same outfit as image 1: sitting cross-legged on the bed, same lamp, pillows and light, same camera position. Her face must stay identical to image 1 and the real photos in images 2 and 3. Do not beautify her.

New pose: she holds an iPhone out in front of her chest with both hands, arms slightly extended, the screen facing the camera, phone held upright and fairly large in frame, her fingers wrapped naturally around the edges. She looks at the camera over the top of the phone with a small knowing smile. On her lap sits [WHERE IT LANDS, e.g. a small white plate with a split scone topped with clotted cream].

The phone screen shows an Instagram post in light mode, sharp and readable: a header with a small round profile photo and the username "[YOUR HANDLE]", then a photo filling most of the screen of [WHAT MELTS, e.g. a pile of glossy ripe red strawberries], then heart, comment and share icons, and the caption "[YOUR HANDLE] [CAPTION]". All text correctly spelt. Photorealistic, five fingers on each hand, no other text, no watermark.



start frame

VIDEO · SEEDANCE 2.5 (AFTER THE OPENING BLOCK)

THE PHONE: she holds the iPhone upright with both hands, screen facing the camera. The Instagram post on screen keeps its header "[YOUR HANDLE]", icons and caption sharp and unchanged.

10-second shot.
0-3 s: She holds the phone still, looking at the camera over the top of it with a small knowing smile.
3-7 s: The [WHAT MELTS] in the photo on the screen begin to MELT, softening and sliding down inside the screen, turning into [WHAT IT BECOMES, e.g. thick shiny strawberry jam with small fruit pieces]. It physically oozes OUT of the screen through the bottom edge of the phone, real and three-dimensional, sticky and glistening, running over her fingers in thick slow drips.
7-9 s: Heavy drops fall from the bottom of the phone straight down onto [WHERE IT LANDS], landing with a soft splat. The photo on the screen is now just an empty white square.
9-10 s: She lowers her eyes to it, then looks back at the camera, delighted, eyebrows up.
AUDIO: quiet room ambience, a soft wet squelch as it melts, slow sticky dripping sounds, a soft splat, a small surprised laugh. No music, no dialogue.

NEGATIVE: no cuts, no extra people, no garbled or changing text on the screen, no new text, no watermark, no captions, no morphing face, no plastic skin, no warped hands, no extra fingers, no dropping the phone, no outfit changes, no cartoon look.

Swap it: chocolate onto a croissant, honey onto toast, paint onto a canvas.

PUT IT TOGETHER

Three clips, *one Reel*

1. Drop the three clips into CapCut, one after another.
2. Trim the slow first second or two of each clip. The effect should start fast.
3. Add a short hook line over the first two seconds. Mine: "3 AI effects that stop the scroll".
4. Name each effect on screen ("the pop out effect", "1/3") so people know it's a series and keep watching.
5. Keep the sound from the clips. Add quiet music underneath if you like.

You don't need a studio, a crew or a new skill set for this. You need one good character sheet, words you check before you animate, and the patience to make one video at a time.

Want the whole system, *not just three prompts?*

This PDF is one workflow. My bootcamp, **Your AI Marketing Team in 14 Days**, gives you one task a day, each with a short video showing every prompt and every click: your character sheet, your first cinematic AI scene, animated carousels Claude builds for you, Reels and YouTube videos edited by Claude, and outreach that turns your new content into clients.

Starts 1 November · 14 days, 14 tasks · $95 · lifetime access

See the bootcamp →

Tag me when you post yours. I want to see what melts out of your phone. 💌